



Recommended Exercise Reflection Guide

Use this guide after completing a recommended exercise in this course.

This guide provides a strong example you can use to assess and improve your own response.

Your response does not need to use the exact same wording. Use the guide to check whether your answer is specific, grounded in the customer or workflow context, and clear about the reasoning behind your decisions.

Assess and Improve Your SDLC Workflow Map

Recommended exercise recap

In the recommended exercise **Map Codex collaboration across the SDLC**, Cavendish Cables has identified five workflow moments where Codex may help.

The workflow moments include local debugging support, recurring CI failure investigation, production deployment approval, pull-request review preparation, and a broad request to “clean up the whole service.”

Your task is to complete Sections 2 and 4–7 of the companion worksheet: **SDLC workflow map, Recommended pair-programming workflows, Recommended governed-delegation workflows, Workflows requiring stronger manual control, and Codex support, engineer ownership, and controls.**

Your response should identify the collaboration pattern, what Codex can support, what engineers still own, and what controls are needed.

For the pull-request workflow, a strong response should state whether the recommendation uses local review preparation or native GitHub code review. Native review can be requested with @codex review or configured to run automatically, and AGENTS.md can supply repository-specific review guidance.

Area	What to assess
SDLC workflow moment	Where the work sits in the software-delivery lifecycle.
Collaboration pattern	Whether the work fits pair programming, governed delegation, review checkpoint, or stronger manual workflow.
Codex support	What Codex can prepare, summarize, investigate, draft, or clarify.
Engineer ownership	What decisions remain human-owned.
Controls needed	What scope, validation, review, approval, or escalation expectations are required.

Assess your response

Review the example below, then compare it with your own response. The goal is not to copy the wording. The goal is to assess whether your answer maps Codex into the SDLC without treating every workflow as a delegation candidate.

As you review the example, pay attention to three things:

- **Different workflows use different patterns.** The response does not force every workflow into the same collaboration model.
- **Engineer ownership is explicit.** The response names decisions that remain human-owned.
- **Controls match the workflow.** The response ties controls to scope, validation, review, approval, and escalation needs.

Worksheet section	Example response
Most important workflow moment to address first	Pull-request review, using local review preparation for this example.
Why this workflow moment should be prioritized	Review friction is repeated, outputs are inspectable, and a named reviewer can remain accountable for approval and merge decisions.
Recommended pair-programming workflow	Local debugging support for a developer actively inspecting a failing function.
Why pair programming fits	The engineer needs interactive help understanding code and can steer the work turn by turn.
Recommended governed-delegation workflow	Recurring CI failure investigation using approved logs and one scoped repository.
Why governed delegation fits	The task is repeated, bounded, context-supported, verifiable, and reviewable if logs, repository scope, validation expectations, and reviewer ownership are defined.
Workflow requiring stronger manual control	Production deployment approval.
Why stronger manual control is needed	Production approval is a high-impact decision and should remain human-led until approval paths, escalation, and governance controls are defined.
What Codex can support	Summarize review context, inspect bounded logs, identify likely causes, draft documentation, and capture handoff notes.
What engineers still own	Architecture judgment, code quality, approval, merge decisions, production release decisions, risk acceptance, and accountability for outcomes.
Controls needed	Approved context, repository boundaries, validation evidence, named review owner, no autonomous approval or merge, stop conditions, and escalation triggers.

Why this example is strong

This example is strong because it applies the Golden Principle: match the collaboration pattern to the workflow, not the other way around.

The response does not recommend Codex everywhere at once. It prioritizes pull-request review preparation because the friction is repeated, the output is inspectable, and a named reviewer can remain accountable.

It also distinguishes collaboration patterns clearly. Local debugging support fits pair programming because the engineer is actively steering the work. Recurring CI failure investigation may fit governed delegation because it can be bounded, supported by approved logs, and reviewed before any code changes. Production deployment approval stays under stronger manual control because approval paths and governance controls are not defined.

The example keeps engineering ownership visible. Codex can summarize, inspect, draft, and capture evidence, but engineers still own architecture judgment, code quality, approval, merge decisions, production release decisions, risk acceptance, and accountability.

The strongest part of the example is that controls are proportionate. The recommendation does not add controls generically. It ties controls to approved context, repository boundaries, validation evidence, named review ownership, restricted approval and merge authority, stop conditions, and escalation triggers.

Reflect on your own response

Compare your response with the example.

Ask yourself:

- Did I map the workflow moment to the SDLC rather than treating it as generic coding work?
- Did I choose different collaboration patterns for different workflow moments where appropriate?
- Did I explain why pair programming, governed delegation, review checkpoint, or stronger manual workflow fits?
- Did I identify what Codex can support without positioning it as the decision-maker?
- Did I name what engineers still own?
- Did I include controls that match the workflow risk and review needs?
- Did I explain what would need to change before a workflow could move to governed delegation?

If your answer is unclear, refine the SDLC workflow map before building the final AI-native engineering workflow recommendation.

OpenAI

